

## Hackers program bacteria

Ok, they were scientists actually, who programmed the fluorescence in bacteria to keep time, essentially turning them into tiny clocks

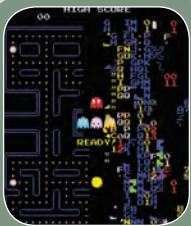
## PETA like the Na'Vi

PETA is extending the definition of animals to include extraterrestrial furries, by awarding James Cameron a prize for showing Aliens as pretty nice beings for a change

Concepts

## Geek culture: Pac-Man

Pacman was one of the first games that a lot of people played, and the fandom for the game is deep enough for this game to have complex strategies based on movement and AI that rivals those that have been developed by players, for say, Quake 3.



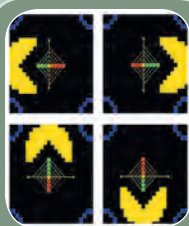
### SPLIT SCREEN

The final level on the original game is unplayable, and it once had a \$100,000 price on its buggy head.



### GHOST MODES

Scatter, Chase and Fright are the three possible ghost behaviors. You can predict these based on your movement.



### CORNERING

Once of the survival tactics, cornering involves giving an instruction to turn before the Pac-Man can perform it.

Analog



### PACMANHATTEN

A real world game played by people who dress up as Pac Man Characters going around the city collecting dots.



### BOARD GAME

Milton Bradley released a board game version two years after the virtual release with LEDs and plastic ghosts



### ROOMBA PAC-MAN

A bunch of students implemented PacMan using five Roomba vacuum cleaners

Media



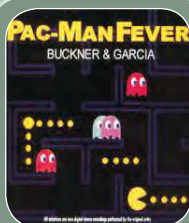
### PACMAN MOVIE

Crystal sky pictures announced a movie in 2004, but the IMDB page has a strange fan video which is a laugh.



### PAC-MAN SERIES

The TV series was one of the first to be based on a video game character, and featured Pac-Man and his family.



### PAC MAN FEVER

Buckner and Garcia's one hit wonder involved the band crooning to how addictive playing Pac-Man was

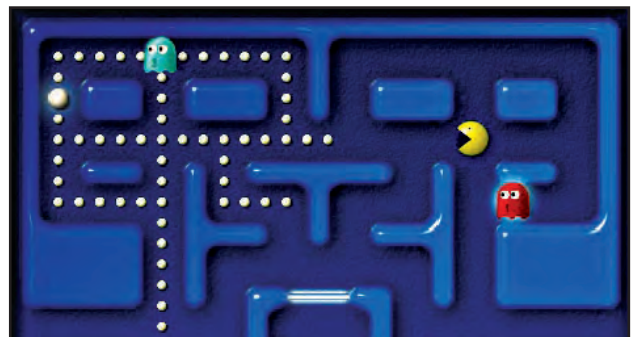
digitDIARY

We have a couple of new people on the team, Nimish and Karan who haven't yet played a game of Quake with the rest of the team. This is the longest ever that new recruits haven't been humiliated by the business end of Rossi's gauntlet. In the virtual world that is.

We moved to a new office space this month, and looking at all the Monitors lined up gave us an idea. We were thinking of a LAN based virtual pet, that can run across screens and basically interact with whoever is free. The client application should be synced in a manner that it understands the real world positions of the screens. We were thinking it would be great to retain or kick this pet from one screen to the next. If you have already began coding such a thing, be sure to send a copy of it to us, and just apply the same to software windows and browsers as well.

## Flash Games: Anti Pac-Man

For over 30 years, Pac-Man has been doing rounds in a maze, gobbling dots and generally giving Inky, Pinky, Blinky and Clyde a hard time. It is finally time for the ghosts to fight back. In Anti-Pacman, you will have to throw three years of gaming inertia to the bin, and play instead as one of the four ghosts. While you are in control of a ghost, the other ghosts behave in classic Pac-Man fashion, and be careful when you turn blue, as Pac-Man can gobble you up then.



### 1337sp33k

Stay up to date with internet lingo, so you don't wt? the next time you are chatting with someone

**froob:** A "freaking n00b", a n00b so n00b that n00bs call him a n00b. Not to be confused with frood.

**frood:** a variant of "cool", to describe a person. Froody is the adjective.

**j00:** slang for the word "you"



### Movies

A Wednesday: We caught up to this movie, has an unusual amount of tech for a Bollywood film, and it's a pretty sensible watch



### Music

We've been listening to some John Wesley, a member of Porcupine Tree. Some of his tracks are free to download.



### Game

AVATAR: The gameplay may suck, but we just like to go sightseeing on Pandora. Demo is on the DVD